HDB Resale Portal impact on agent opportunity

Management briefing | Section 1 Question 1

Data period: 2017-01 to 2026-06. Latest complete year: 2025.

Sources: CEA salesperson-side records; registered HDB resale transactions from HDB resale flat prices

Executive answer: no sustained collapse in salesperson-side records

76.0%
2017 baseline record rate
Pre-portal reference proxy

79.2%
2025 record rate
+3.2 pp vs 2017

-440
Cumulative gap, 2018-2025
Agent sides vs 2017-rate expectation

CEA salesperson-side records did not disappear after the portal launch; the latest complete year is above the 2017 baseline.
The 2018-2025 cumulative gap is close to zero, so the data does not support a large sustained displacement story.
Impact is better described as channel and role change: self-service became easier, but many buyer/seller sides still used agents.

Sources: CEA salesperson-side records; registered HDB resale transactions from HDB resale flat prices

Metric design: compare registered transactions with CEA salesperson-side records

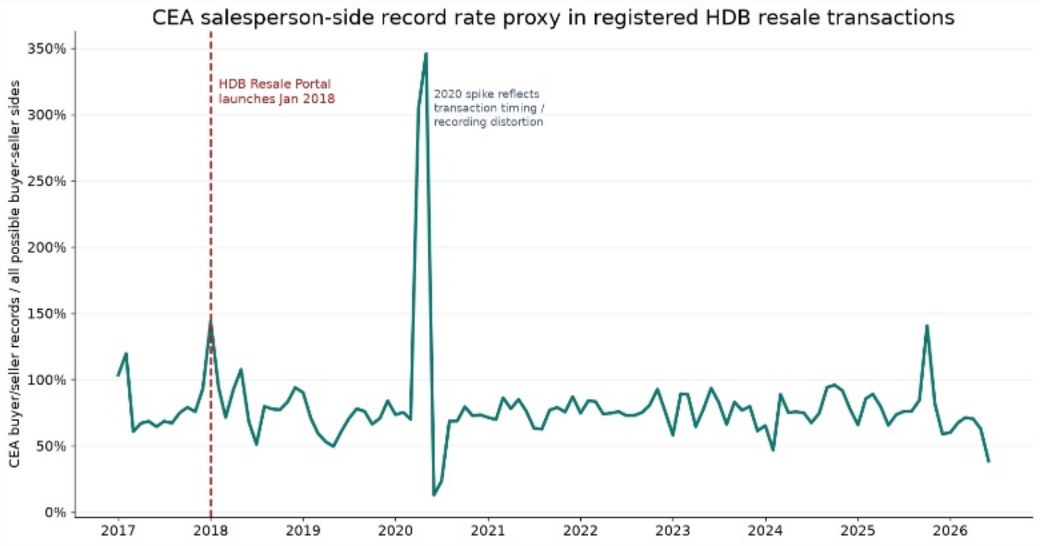
The datasets count different units

HDB resale data counts registered HDB resale transactions.
CEA data counts salesperson-side records by represented side.
One resale can create multiple CEA rows because the data is not a unique deal registry.
No shared transaction ID means we should avoid claiming the exact share of deals with at least one agent.

Agent-side record rate = CEA buyer/seller salesperson-side records / (2 × registered HDB resale transactions)

EVIDENCE

Trend: the portal did not produce a permanent step-down



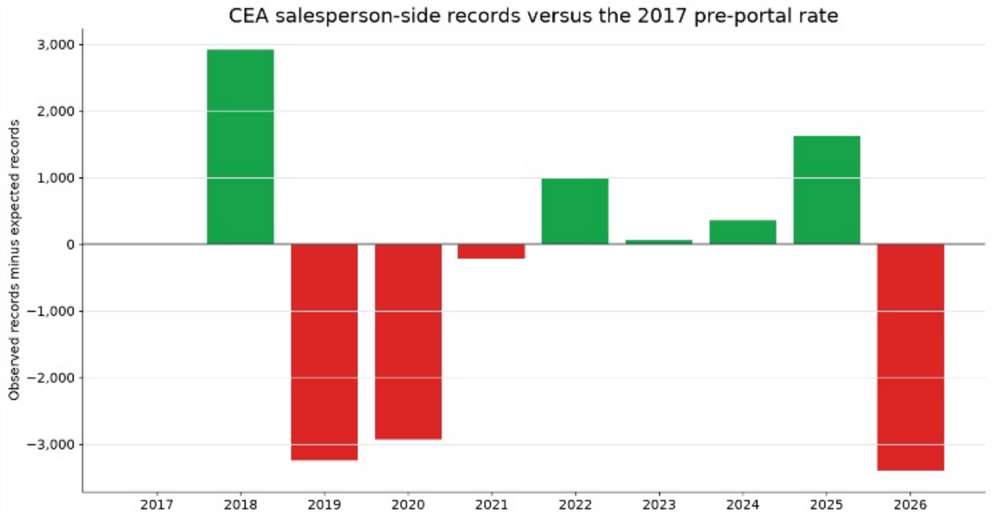
The record-rate proxy rose in 2018, fell in 2019-2020, and then recovered.

The 2026 data is partial through June and should not be treated as a full-year result.

Movement after 2018 likely reflects broader market conditions as well as portal adoption.

Sources: CEA salesperson-side records; registered HDB resale transactions from HDB resale flat prices

Business impact: records fluctuated around baseline

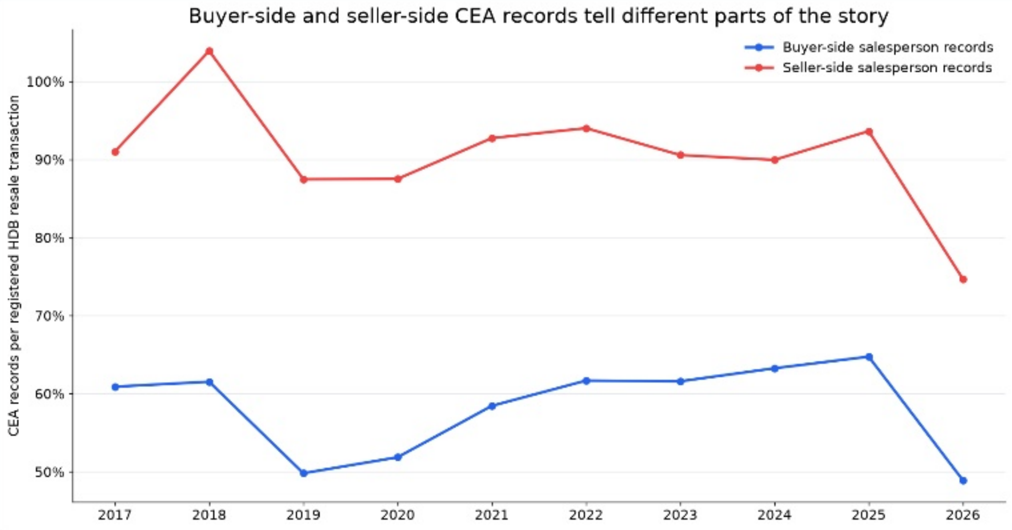


Headline calculation

At the 2017 rate, 2025 would have had 38,115 CEA salesperson-side records.
Observed 2025: 39,733 records, or 1,618 above baseline expectation.
The complete post-launch period nets to a small negative gap, not a structural wipeout.

Sources: CEA salesperson-side records; registered HDB resale transactions from HDB resale flat prices

Buyer and seller records show where service remains sticky



+3.8 pp

Buyer-side change

60.9% to 64.8%

+2.6 pp

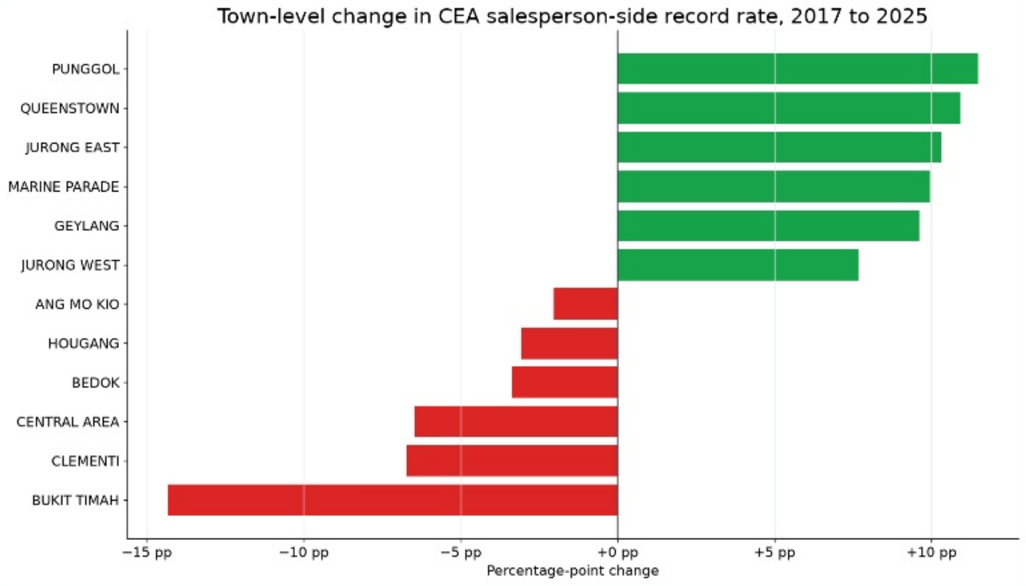
Seller-side change

91.0% to 93.6%

Seller-side records remain especially high, suggesting continued demand for pricing, negotiation, and completion support.

Sources: CEA salesperson-side records; registered HDB resale transactions from HDB resale flat prices

Town-level variation points to segmented adoption



Some towns show lower agent-side record rates than in 2017, while others increased materially.
This argues for town, flat-type, and price-band segmentation before drawing product or outreach conclusions.
Public communication should emphasise choice: DIY is easier, agent value remains situational.

Sources: CEA salesperson-side records; registered HDB resale transactions from HDB resale flat prices

SEGMENTATION

Estate maturity and land-price context refine town variation

Why this matters

HDB classified mature estates as places with limited land for public housing and high demand.
HDB notes that BTO flats in mature estates tend to be sold at higher prices to reflect locational attributes and demand.
Therefore, town-level agent-rate changes should be read alongside estate maturity and price/land-value context.

74.7%
Mature estates, 2025
+1.5 pp vs 2017

82.4%
Non-mature estates, 2025
+4.3 pp vs 2017

$674,888
Mature median resale
2025, 10.6% above non-mature

$610,000
Non-mature median resale
2025 median resale price

Management implication

Do not rank towns on agent-side record rate alone. Control for mature/non-mature status, resale price band, flat type, and lease profile before deciding whether a town reflects self-service adoption, higher transaction complexity, or location-driven price effects.

Sources: HDB Annex A, Background of mature/non-mature classification; registered HDB resale transactions from HDB resale flat prices; CEA salesperson-side records.

Management execution: make the insight actionable

Strong analytical actions

Use agent-side record rate as the defensible opportunity proxy; avoid calling it exact penetration.
Use complete years for headlines; keep partial years as monitoring only.
Run data-quality checks for months where records exceed a literal 100% side interpretation.
Treat Jan 2018 as an event marker, not causal proof.

Execution levers

Segment by buyer/seller side, town, flat type, price band, and lease profile to target action.
Separate transaction opportunity from commission revenue.
Estimate revenue exposure only through low/base/high commission scenarios.
Focus service design on pricing, negotiation, documentation, and complex cases.

Sources: CEA salesperson-side records; registered HDB resale transactions from HDB resale flat prices

Additional considerations and improvement

Weaker as management evidence, useful for public perception

Improve the public hook: start with the reader question, "If DIY became easier, did people stop using agents?"
Make the conclusion more explicit: the evidence suggests resilient CEA salesperson-side records and shifted agent value, not simple replacement.
Use annual charts more prominently for the public story; keep monthly charts as diagnostics for timing noise.
Use annotated charts and friendly visuals to improve comprehension, while keeping evidence and caveats separate from design polish.

These improvements help the story land with regular readers, but they do not replace the stronger analytical work: metric defensibility, segmentation, causality limits, revenue scenarios, and complete-year discipline.

Sources: CEA salesperson-side records; registered HDB resale transactions from HDB resale flat prices